Personalized Meal Plan

by Diabetes and Endocrinology Centre

Consolidated Meal Plan

Meal Plan

Day	Breakfast	Lunch	Dinner	Snacks
Monday	Chia seed pudding with almond milk and berries	Air-fried paneer tikka with quinoa and mixed greens	Instant Pot vegetable biryani (millet-based, low sodium)	Roasted chana and spiced almonds
Tuesday	Gluten-free moong dal chilla with mint chutney	Lentil and vegetable stew with brown rice	Lauki (bottle gourd) and lentil curry with quinoa	Sliced apple with peanut butter
Wednesday	Spicy tofu scramble with spinach and bell peppers	Gluten-free spicy rajma salad bowl	Air-fried masala broccoli with grilled halloumi	Homemade trail mix (pumpkin seeds, walnuts, dried berries)
Thursday	Instant Pot steel-cut oats with cinnamon and walnuts	Grilled tofu shawarma bowl with tabbouleh (quinoa-based)	Zucchini noodles with spicy marinara and grilled tofu	Air-fried spicy chickpeas
Friday	Vegetable upma (millet-based, gluten-free)	Mixed bean salad with roasted sweet potato	Stuffed bell peppers with black beans and corn	Cucumber sticks with hummus
Saturday	High-protein Greek yogurt parfait with flaxseed and strawberries	Chickpea and avocado lettuce wraps with spicy dressing	Cabbage and paneer stir-fry with garlic	Greek yogurt with blueberries and chia seeds
Sunday	Besan (chickpea flour) pancakes with tomato salsa	Vegetarian Thai curry with tofu and cauliflower rice	Eggplant and chickpea curry with brown rice	Carrot and celery sticks with spicy roasted moong dip

Recipes

Chia Seed Pudding with Almond Milk and Berries (Diabetes-Friendly, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 170 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 11g (fiber: 7g, net carbs: 4g)
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• Chia seeds, whole – 3 tablespoons (30g)
• Unsweetened almond milk – 1 cup (240ml)
• Vanilla extract (alcohol-free, optional) – 1/4 teaspoon
• Fresh mixed berries (raspberries, blueberries, strawberries), chopped – 1/3 cup (50g)
• Plant-based protein powder (unflavored or vanilla, low-carb, low-sodium) – 1 tablespoon (10g)
• Stevia or monk fruit sweetener (optional) – to taste, up to 1/2 teaspoon

Instructions

1. In a mixing bowl or jar, combine chia seeds, plant-based protein powder, and sweetener (if using).
2. Pour in the unsweetened almond milk and add vanilla extract. Stir well until ingredients are evenly mixed and there are no clumps.
3. Cover and refrigerate for at least 3-4 hours, or overnight, until the pudding thickens to a creamy consistency.
4. Before serving, stir the pudding once more to evenly distribute seeds.
5. Top with fresh mixed berries just before serving.
6. Optional: For a smoother texture, blend the pudding in a blender after soaking and before adding the berries.

Gluten-Free Moong Dal Chilla with Mint Chutney

Nutritional Information

Calories: 175 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 23g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Split yellow moong dal (mung beans, dry) – 1 cup (200g)
• Filtered water – for soaking and blending (about 1.5 cups total)
• Fresh spinach leaves – 1 cup (30g), finely chopped
• Carrot – 1 small (50g), grated
• Red onion – 1/4 small (25g), finely diced
• Fresh coriander leaves – 2 tbsp, chopped
• Green chili – 1 small, deseeded and minced (optional, for mild heat)
• Ginger – 1/2 inch piece, grated
• Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
• Black pepper – 1/4 tsp
• Cold-pressed extra-virgin olive oil – 2 tsp (for chilla cooking, divided)
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional) – 1/4 tsp (or omit)
• FOR MINT CHUTNEY:
• Fresh mint leaves – 1/2 cup (15g), packed
• Fresh coriander leaves – 1/4 cup (8g), packed
• Plain low-fat Greek yogurt – 1/4 cup (60g)
• Lemon juice – 1 tbsp
• Ginger – 1/2 inch piece
• Roasted cumin powder – 1/4 tsp
• Black pepper – 1/8 tsp
• Filtered water – 2 tbsp (as needed for blending)

Instructions

1. Rinse the moong dal thoroughly and soak in filtered water for at least 3 hours or overnight in the fridge. Drain and rinse again before use.

2. In a blender, combine soaked, drained moong dal with 1/2 cup filtered water, ginger, green chili (if using), cumin seeds, turmeric, and black pepper. Blend until you have a smooth, thick batter. Add extra water as needed to reach a pancake-batter consistency (not too runny).
3. Transfer batter to a bowl. Stir in chopped spinach, grated carrot, diced red onion, and coriander leaves. Mix well. Taste and add salt substitute if using, or omit for strict low-sodium needs.
4. Preheat a non-stick skillet or use an air fryer with a flat tray at 180°C (355°F). Lightly brush with 1 tsp olive oil.
5. Pour a ladleful (~1/4 cup) of batter onto the hot surface, spreading gently to form a 5-6 inch chilla. Cook on medium heat for 2-3 minutes or until the edges start to lift and the underside is golden.
6. Drizzle or brush a few drops of olive oil around the edges. Flip and cook another 2 minutes until cooked through. Repeat with remaining batter, using another teaspoon of oil as needed. Makes 4 medium chillas.
7. For the mint chutney: Blend mint, coriander, Greek yogurt, lemon juice, ginger, cumin powder, black pepper, and 2 tbsp water until smooth. Taste and adjust lemon or water for consistency.
8. Serve chillas warm, with 2 tbsp mint chutney per serving.

Spicy Tofu Scramble with Spinach and Bell Peppers

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 13g

Ingredients

• 200g (7 oz) firm tofu, drained and pressed
• 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil (or canola oil)
• 1/2 medium red bell pepper, diced (about 60g)
• 1/2 medium yellow bell pepper, diced (about 60g)
• 2 cups fresh spinach, chopped (about 60g)
• 1/4 cup chopped red onion (about 30g)
• 1 small garlic clove, minced
• 1/2 teaspoon ground turmeric
• 1/2 teaspoon smoked paprika

• 1/4 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/4 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (optional, adjust to spice tolerance)
• 1/8 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon fresh lemon juice
• 1 tablespoon chopped fresh parsley or cilantro (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the tofu: Drain the tofu and press it gently to remove excess moisture. Crumble it into small pieces using your hands or a fork.
2. 2. Heat the oil: In a large nonstick skillet or using the sauté function of the Instant Pot, heat the olive oil over medium heat.
3. 3. Sauté aromatics: Add the chopped onion and minced garlic to the pan. Sauté for 1-2 minutes until fragrant and slightly softened.
4. 4. Add peppers: Add the diced red and yellow bell peppers. Sauté for another 3-4 minutes until they begin to soften.
5. 5. Add spices: Sprinkle in the turmeric, smoked paprika, cumin, red pepper flakes (if using), and black pepper. Stir well to coat the vegetables.
6. 6. Add tofu: Add the crumbled tofu to the pan. Stir to combine and cook for 4-5 minutes, allowing the tofu to absorb the spices and heat through.
7. 7. Add spinach: Add the chopped spinach and cook, stirring frequently, until just wilted (about 1-2 minutes).
8. 8. Finish: Turn off the heat. Stir in the fresh lemon juice. Taste and adjust black pepper if desired.
9. 9. Serve: Garnish with chopped fresh parsley or cilantro if desired. Serve immediately.

Instant Pot Steel-Cut Oats with Cinnamon and Walnuts (Diabetes-Friendly, Low Sodium, Vegetarian, High Protein)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 9g
Carbs: 25g
Fat: 9g

Ingredients

• Steel-cut oats, gluten-free – 1/2 cup (dry, 40g)

• Water – 1 1/4 cups (300 ml)
• Unsweetened soy milk (fortified) – 1/4 cup (60 ml)
• Chopped raw walnuts – 2 tablespoons (14g)
• Ground cinnamon – 1 teaspoon
• Chia seeds – 1 tablespoon (10g)
• Vanilla extract – 1/2 teaspoon
• Salt – 0 (omit for low sodium)
• Optional: Stevia or monk fruit extract – to taste (avoid sugar or honey)

Instructions

1. Add the steel-cut oats, water, and unsweetened soy milk to the Instant Pot inner pot.
2. Stir in cinnamon, chia seeds, and vanilla extract. Do not add walnuts yet (they will be added after cooking to preserve their healthy fats).
3. Seal the lid and set the valve to 'Sealing.'
4. Select 'Pressure Cook' or 'Manual' and set for 4 minutes at high pressure.
5. After cooking, allow a natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then carefully quick-release any remaining pressure.
6. Open the lid and stir the oats. The consistency should be creamy; if too thick, add a splash of soy milk.
7. Stir in the chopped walnuts.
8. Taste and, if desired, add a small amount of stevia or monk fruit extract for sweetness.
9. Serve hot. Portion is for 2 servings.

Low-Carb Millet Vegetable Upma (Diabetes & Heart Healthy)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 27g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• Little millet (samai) or foxtail millet, dry – 1/2 cup (70g)

- Water – 1 1/4 cups (300ml)
- Olive oil (extra virgin) – 2 tsp
- Mustard seeds – 1/2 tsp
- Cumin seeds – 1/2 tsp
- Fresh ginger, finely grated – 1 tsp
- Green chili, finely chopped – 1 small (optional, for flavor, not heat)
- Onion, finely chopped – 1/4 cup (35g)
- Carrot, diced small – 1/4 cup (30g)
- Green beans, diced – 1/4 cup (30g)
- Red bell pepper, diced – 1/4 cup (30g)
- Frozen green peas – 2 tbsp (20g)
- Fresh spinach, chopped – 1/4 cup (15g)
- Unsalted roasted peanuts, coarsely crushed – 1 tbsp (optional, for protein)
- Lemon juice – 1 tbsp (for finishing)
- Fresh coriander/cilantro, chopped – 1 tbsp
- Ground black pepper – 1/4 tsp
- Turmeric powder – 1/4 tsp
- Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional) – 1/8 tsp or to taste (see tips)
- Filtered water – as needed for rinsing

Instructions

1. Rinse millet thoroughly under running water. Drain well.
2. Using the Instant Pot on 'Sauté' mode, add olive oil. When warm, add mustard seeds and cumin seeds. Allow them to splutter (~30 sec).
3. Add grated ginger and (optional) green chili. Sauté for 30 seconds.
4. Add onions. Sauté for 2 minutes until translucent.
5. Stir in diced carrot, green beans, red bell pepper, and peas. Sauté for 3 minutes.
6. Add turmeric and black pepper. Mix well.
7. Add rinsed millet. Stir to coat grains in spices and oil.
8. Pour in 1 1/4 cups water. Add salt substitute if using.
9. Seal Instant Pot. Cook on 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' mode for 7 minutes. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release.
10. Open lid. Add chopped spinach and lemon juice. Fluff gently with a fork.
11. Sprinkle crushed peanuts and coriander on top before serving.

High-Protein Lentil & Vegetable Stew (Instant Pot, Gluten-Free, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 14g
Carbs: 35g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

- 1 cup dry green or brown lentils, rinsed
- 1 cup chopped carrots
- 1 cup chopped celery
- 1 cup diced zucchini
- 1 cup chopped red bell pepper
- 1 cup chopped tomatoes (fresh or no-salt-added canned)
- 2 cups fresh spinach
- 1 small yellow onion, diced
- 3 cloves garlic, minced
- 4 cups water
- 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon dried thyme
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1/2 teaspoon turmeric powder
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley
- Juice of 1/2 lemon

Instructions

1. Set the Instant Pot to sauté mode. Add olive oil and onion; cook for 2–3 minutes until softened.
2. Add garlic and cook for 1 minute, stirring frequently.
3. Add the carrots, celery, bell pepper, zucchini, and tomatoes. Sauté for another 2–3 minutes.

4. Add the lentils, thyme, oregano, smoked paprika, turmeric, and black pepper. Stir well.
5. Pour in 4 cups of water and stir to combine.
6. Seal the Instant Pot lid and set to 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' mode for 12 minutes.
7. When cooking is complete, allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.
8. Open the lid, add spinach and lemon juice, and stir until spinach wilts.
9. Taste and adjust black pepper if needed. Serve hot, garnished with fresh parsley.

High-Protein Greek Yogurt Parfait with Flaxseed and Strawberries

Nutritional Information

Calories: 180 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 11g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• 3/4 cup (170g) nonfat plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened, no added sodium)
• 1/2 cup (75g) fresh strawberries, sliced
• 1 tablespoon ground flaxseed (7g)
• 1 tablespoon unsalted raw almonds, chopped (8g)
• 1/4 teaspoon pure vanilla extract (optional, alcohol-free)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon (optional)
• 2-3 drops liquid stevia or monk fruit sweetener (optional, to taste)

Instructions

1. Wash and slice the strawberries. Set aside.
2. In a small bowl, mix the Greek yogurt with vanilla extract, cinnamon, and sweetener (if using). Stir well until smooth.
3. In a parfait or serving glass, layer half of the yogurt mixture at the bottom.
4. Sprinkle half of the ground flaxseed and half of the chopped almonds over the yogurt.
5. Add half of the sliced strawberries as the next layer.

6. Repeat the layers: remaining yogurt, then the rest of the flaxseed, almonds, and strawberries.
7. Serve immediately, or cover and refrigerate for up to 24 hours.

Besan (Chickpea Flour) Pancakes with Tomato Salsa

Nutritional Information

Calories: 165 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• 1 cup (120g) besan (chickpea flour)
• 3/4 cup (180ml) water
• 1/4 cup (30g) finely chopped red onion
• 1/4 cup (30g) finely chopped baby spinach
• 2 tablespoons chopped fresh coriander (cilantro)
• 1/2 teaspoon turmeric powder
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil (for cooking, divided)
• For Tomato Salsa:
• 1 medium (120g) ripe tomato, finely diced
• 2 tablespoons finely chopped red onion
• 1 tablespoon chopped fresh coriander (cilantro)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/4 teaspoon black pepper
• 1 teaspoon fresh squeezed lemon juice

Instructions

1. 1. In a mixing bowl, combine besan, turmeric, cumin, and black pepper.
2. 2. Gradually whisk in the water to form a smooth, lump-free batter.
3. 3. Stir in chopped onion, spinach, and fresh coriander.
4. 4. Let the batter rest for 10 minutes to hydrate.
5. 5. While the batter rests, prepare the salsa: In a small bowl, combine diced tomato, red onion, coriander, cumin, black pepper, and lemon juice. Mix well and set aside.
6. 6. Heat a non-stick skillet or use an air fryer with a flat tray. Lightly brush with half the olive oil.
7. 7. Pour 1/4 cup of batter per pancake onto the hot surface. Spread gently to about 4 inches diameter.
8. 8. Cook over medium heat for 2-3 minutes until bubbles form and edges lift easily.
9. 9. Flip pancake and cook the other side for 1-2 minutes until golden and set. Repeat with remaining batter, using the rest of the oil as needed.
10. 10. Serve pancakes warm with fresh tomato salsa spooned on top.

Air-Fried Paneer Tikka with Quinoa and Mixed Greens

Nutritional Information

Calories: 325 kcal
Protein: 20g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 17g

Ingredients

• Paneer (low-fat, unsalted): 150g, cubed
• Low-fat plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened): 60g (about 1/4 cup)
• Lemon juice: 1 tablespoon
• Fresh ginger, grated: 1 teaspoon
• Fresh garlic, minced: 1 teaspoon
• Ground cumin: 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground coriander: 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground turmeric: 1/4 teaspoon
• Paprika: 1/2 teaspoon
• Black pepper: 1/4 teaspoon

• Olive oil (extra-virgin): 1 teaspoon
• Fresh cilantro, chopped: 1 tablespoon
• Cooked quinoa (unsalted): 1/3 cup (about 60g cooked)
• Mixed salad greens (baby spinach, arugula, romaine): 1 cup (30g)
• Cherry tomatoes, halved: 4 (about 30g)
• Cucumber, diced: 1/4 cup (30g)
• Red onion, thinly sliced: 2 tablespoons (optional, about 10g)
• Fresh mint leaves, chopped: 1 tablespoon
• Freshly ground black pepper (for salad): pinch
• Lemon juice (for salad): 1 teaspoon

Instructions

1. In a medium bowl, mix Greek yogurt, 1 tablespoon lemon juice, ginger, garlic, cumin, coriander, turmeric, paprika, black pepper, and olive oil to make the marinade.
2. Add paneer cubes to the marinade, toss gently to coat, cover, and refrigerate for at least 20 minutes (or up to 2 hours for deeper flavor).
3. Preheat the air fryer to 190°C (375°F).
4. Lightly spray or brush the air fryer basket with a small amount of olive oil (optional, to prevent sticking).
5. Arrange marinated paneer cubes in a single layer in the air fryer basket (do not overcrowd).
6. Air-fry for 8-10 minutes, turning halfway, until paneer is golden and slightly crispy at the edges. Set aside to cool for 2-3 minutes.
7. While paneer is cooking, fluff the cooked quinoa with a fork. In a large bowl, combine mixed greens, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red onion, mint, and cilantro.
8. Add the quinoa to the salad bowl and toss gently. Drizzle with 1 teaspoon lemon juice and a pinch of black pepper.
9. Serve the salad on a plate and top with warm air-fried paneer tikka cubes.

Lentil and Vegetable Stew with Brown Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 290 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 48g
Fat: 5.5g

Ingredients

- Brown lentils, dry – 1/2 cup (100g), rinsed
- Brown basmati rice – 1/2 cup (90g), rinsed
- Extra-virgin olive oil – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
- Yellow onion – 1 medium (120g), diced
- Carrot – 1 medium (60g), diced
- Celery – 1 stalk (40g), diced
- Zucchini – 1 small (100g), diced
- Red bell pepper – 1 small (80g), diced
- Fresh garlic – 2 cloves, minced
- Fresh spinach – 2 cups (60g), roughly chopped
- No-salt-added diced tomatoes – 1 can (400g/14oz), drained
- Low-sodium vegetable broth – 2 cups (480ml)
- Bay leaf – 1
- Dried thyme – 1/2 teaspoon
- Dried oregano – 1/2 teaspoon
- Black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
- Fresh lemon juice – 1 tablespoon (15ml)
- Fresh parsley – 2 tablespoons, chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Using the Instant Pot (or stovetop), set to 'Sauté' mode. Add olive oil, then onion, carrot, and celery. Sauté for 3-4 minutes until softened.
2. Add garlic, zucchini, and bell pepper. Sauté for another 2 minutes.
3. Add lentils, drained diced tomatoes, thyme, oregano, bay leaf, and black pepper. Stir to combine.
4. Pour in vegetable broth. Stir well. Cancel 'Sauté' mode.
5. Seal the Instant Pot. Set to 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' on high for 12 minutes.
6. Meanwhile, cook brown basmati rice: In a separate pot or the Instant Pot (after stew), add rice and 1 cup (240ml) water. Bring to a boil, then cover and simmer for 25-30 minutes (or use the rice function on the Instant Pot).
7. After lentil stew finishes cooking, allow a natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.
8. Stir in chopped spinach and lemon juice. Let spinach wilt for 2-3 minutes with the lid on (no heat needed).
9. Remove bay leaf. Taste and adjust seasoning if needed (no added salt recommended for low sodium).
10. Serve stew over brown rice, garnished with fresh parsley if desired.

Gluten-Free Spicy Rajma Salad Bowl

Nutritional Information

Calories: 235 kcal
Protein: 10g
Carbs: 29g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

- Dried red kidney beans (rajma), 1/2 cup (soaked overnight, about 90g dry)
- Water, 3 cups (for pressure cooking beans)
- Cherry tomatoes, 6 (about 90g), halved
- English cucumber, 1/2 medium (about 100g), diced
- Red bell pepper, 1/2 medium (about 60g), diced
- Red onion, 1/4 small (about 20g), finely chopped
- Fresh coriander leaves, 2 tablespoons, chopped
- Fresh mint leaves, 1 tablespoon, chopped
- Avocado, 1/4 medium (about 35g), diced
- Lemon juice, freshly squeezed, 1 tablespoon
- Extra-virgin olive oil, 1 teaspoon
- Roasted cumin powder, 1/4 teaspoon
- Smoked paprika, 1/4 teaspoon
- Black pepper, freshly ground, 1/4 teaspoon
- Green chili, 1 small (optional, deseeded and finely chopped)
- Salt substitute (potassium-based, if approved by physician), 1/8 teaspoon (optional)

Instructions

1. Rinse and soak the dried kidney beans overnight in plenty of water. Drain and rinse before using.

2. Add soaked kidney beans and 3 cups of fresh water to the Instant Pot. Cook on high pressure for 18 minutes, then allow natural release for 10 minutes before manually releasing remaining pressure. Drain and let cool to room temperature.
3. In a large mixing bowl, combine cooked kidney beans, cherry tomatoes, cucumber, red bell pepper, red onion, coriander, mint, and avocado.
4. In a small bowl, whisk together lemon juice, olive oil, cumin powder, smoked paprika, black pepper, and green chili (if using). If your physician has approved a potassium-based salt substitute, add it now.
5. Pour the dressing over the salad and toss gently until well combined.
6. Taste and adjust seasoning with more lemon juice or black pepper as desired.
7. Serve immediately, or refrigerate for up to 2 days in an airtight container.

Grilled Tofu Shawarma Bowl with Quinoa Tabbouleh

Nutritional Information

Calories: 320 kcal
Protein: 19g
Carbs: 28g
Fat: 14g

Ingredients

• Extra-firm tofu, drained and pressed - 200g (about 7oz)
• Olive oil, extra virgin - 2 teaspoons
• Fresh lemon juice - 2 tablespoons (divided)
• Low-sodium soy sauce or tamari (gluten-free) - 1 teaspoon
• Ground cumin - 1 teaspoon
• Ground coriander - 1 teaspoon
• Smoked paprika - 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground turmeric - 1/2 teaspoon
• Garlic powder - 1/2 teaspoon
• Black pepper, freshly ground - 1/4 teaspoon
• Quinoa, dry - 1/3 cup (about 60g)
• Water (for quinoa) - 2/3 cup
• Fresh parsley, finely chopped - 1/2 cup

• Fresh mint, finely chopped - 2 tablespoons
• Cucumber, diced - 1/2 cup
• Cherry tomatoes, quartered - 1/2 cup
• Red onion, finely diced - 2 tablespoons
• Olive oil, extra virgin (for tabbouleh) - 1 teaspoon
• Freshly ground black pepper (for tabbouleh) - 1/8 teaspoon
• Romaine lettuce or baby spinach, chopped - 1 cup

Instructions

1. 1. Prepare the tofu: Slice the pressed tofu into 1/2-inch thick slabs or cubes.
2. 2. In a bowl, mix 2 teaspoons olive oil, 1 tablespoon lemon juice, 1 teaspoon low-sodium soy sauce, cumin, coriander, smoked paprika, turmeric, garlic powder, and 1/4 teaspoon black pepper. Toss tofu in marinade and let sit for at least 15 minutes (up to 1 hour in fridge for more flavor).
3. 3. While tofu marinates, rinse quinoa thoroughly. Combine quinoa and water in Instant Pot. Cook on high pressure for 1 minute, then let natural release for 10 minutes. Fluff with fork and cool.
4. 4. Prepare the tabbouleh: In a large bowl, combine cooled quinoa, parsley, mint, cucumber, tomatoes, red onion, 1 tablespoon lemon juice, 1 teaspoon olive oil, and 1/8 teaspoon black pepper. Mix well.
5. 5. Grill tofu: Preheat air fryer to 400°F (200°C). Place marinated tofu pieces in a single layer and air fry for 10-12 minutes, flipping halfway, until golden and crisp. (Alternatively, use a stovetop grill pan with minimal oil.)
6. 6. To assemble: Place a bed of chopped romaine or spinach in a bowl. Top with a generous scoop of quinoa tabbouleh, then arrange grilled tofu on top.
7. 7. Optional: Garnish with extra parsley or a lemon wedge.

Mixed Bean Salad with Roasted Sweet Potato (Low Sodium, Low Carb, High Protein, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 315 kcal
Protein: 14 g
Carbs: 44 g
Fat: 6 g

Ingredients

- 1 medium sweet potato (approx. 180g), peeled and cut into 1 cm cubes
- 1 cup cooked no-salt-added chickpeas (drained and rinsed, or cook from dry, approx. 165g)
- 1 cup cooked no-salt-added kidney beans (drained and rinsed, or cook from dry, approx. 160g)
- 1 cup cooked no-salt-added black beans (drained and rinsed, or cook from dry, approx. 170g)
- 1/2 cup diced cucumber
- 1/2 cup cherry tomatoes, halved
- 1/4 cup finely diced red onion
- 1/4 cup chopped fresh parsley
- 1 tbsp extra virgin olive oil
- 2 tbsp fresh lemon juice
- 1/2 tsp ground cumin
- 1/2 tsp smoked paprika
- 1/4 tsp black pepper
- 1/2 tsp garlic powder

Instructions

1. Preheat air fryer to 200°C (390°F). Toss sweet potato cubes with 1/2 tbsp olive oil, 1/4 tsp black pepper, and 1/2 tsp smoked paprika. Place in air fryer basket in a single layer and roast for 12–15 minutes, shaking halfway, until tender and edges are crisp. Set aside to cool.
2. If using canned beans, drain and rinse thoroughly under cold water to reduce sodium content. Pat dry. If cooking from dry, soak overnight, cook using Instant Pot or stovetop, and cool completely.
3. In a large bowl, combine chickpeas, kidney beans, black beans, cucumber, cherry tomatoes, red onion, and parsley.
4. In a small bowl, whisk together the remaining 1/2 tbsp olive oil, lemon juice, ground cumin, garlic powder, and a pinch more black pepper.
5. Add cooled roasted sweet potato to the bean and vegetable mixture.
6. Pour dressing over the salad and toss gently to combine. Taste and adjust lemon juice or pepper as needed. Serve chilled or at room temperature.

Chickpea and Avocado Lettuce Wraps with Spicy Dressing

Nutritional Information

Calories: 180 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 8g

Ingredients

• 1 cup canned no-salt-added chickpeas, drained and rinsed
• 1 ripe avocado (medium), diced
• 8 large leaves romaine or butter lettuce, washed and patted dry
• 1/4 cup red bell pepper, finely diced
• 1/4 cup English cucumber, finely diced
• 2 tablespoons fresh cilantro, chopped
• 1 tablespoon fresh lime juice
• 1 tablespoon plain low-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened, optional for creaminess)
• 1 teaspoon extra virgin olive oil
• 1/4 teaspoon smoked paprika
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/8 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (adjust to taste)
• 1 small clove garlic, minced
• Freshly ground black pepper, to taste

Instructions

1. In a medium bowl, lightly mash the chickpeas using a fork or potato masher, leaving some texture.
2. Add diced avocado, red bell pepper, cucumber, and cilantro to the chickpeas. Gently combine.
3. In a small bowl, whisk together lime juice, Greek yogurt (if using), olive oil, smoked paprika, cumin, red pepper flakes, minced garlic, and freshly ground black pepper.
4. Pour the spicy dressing over the chickpea mixture and fold gently until well combined. Taste and adjust seasoning, adding more lime juice or pepper as needed.
5. Lay out washed lettuce leaves and spoon the chickpea-avocado mixture evenly among them (about 2 tablespoons per leaf).
6. Serve immediately as open-faced wraps, or fold leaves to eat taco-style.

Vegetarian Thai Curry with Tofu and Cauliflower Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 285 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 15g

Ingredients

• Firm tofu, drained and cubed – 200g (about 7 oz)
• Cauliflower florets (for rice) – 400g (about 1 medium head)
• Extra-virgin olive oil – 1 tablespoon
• Low-sodium vegetable broth – 1/2 cup (120 ml)
• Light coconut milk (unsweetened) – 3/4 cup (180 ml)
• Red bell pepper, sliced – 1 medium (about 120g)
• Zucchini, sliced – 1 small (about 120g)
• Carrot, julienned or thinly sliced – 1 small (about 60g)
• Fresh spinach – 2 cups (about 60g)
• Fresh ginger, grated – 1 teaspoon
• Garlic, minced – 2 cloves
• Thai red curry paste, low sodium, vegetarian – 1.5 tablespoons
• Lime juice, fresh – 1 tablespoon
• Tamari (low sodium, gluten-free soy sauce) – 1 teaspoon
• Fresh cilantro or Thai basil, chopped – 2 tablespoons (for garnish)
• Black pepper – 1/8 teaspoon

Instructions

1. Press tofu for 15-20 minutes to remove excess moisture. Cut into 1-inch cubes.
2. Prepare cauliflower rice: Pulse cauliflower florets in a blender or food processor until rice-like consistency. Set aside.
3. Using the Air Fryer (or oven), lightly brush tofu cubes with 1/2 tablespoon olive oil and air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 12-15 minutes, shaking halfway, until golden and slightly crisp.
4. Meanwhile, heat remaining 1/2 tablespoon olive oil in Instant Pot (on sauté mode) or a large nonstick pan over medium heat.

5. Add garlic and ginger, sauté 30 seconds until fragrant.
6. Add red curry paste, cook 1 minute, stirring constantly.
7. Add bell pepper, zucchini, and carrot; sauté 2-3 minutes.
8. Pour in low-sodium vegetable broth and coconut milk. Stir well. Simmer for 3-4 minutes.
9. Add air-fried tofu and spinach to the curry. Simmer another 2-3 minutes, until spinach is wilted and vegetables are tender but not mushy.
10. Stir in lime juice, tamari, and black pepper. Adjust seasonings if needed (avoid extra salt).
11. While curry simmers, microwave cauliflower rice in a microwave-safe bowl for 3-4 minutes, covered, until tender. Fluff with fork.
12. To serve: Divide cauliflower rice among bowls, top with curry. Garnish with fresh cilantro or Thai basil.

Instant Pot Vegetable Millet Biryani (Low Carb, Vegetarian, Gluten-Free)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 202 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 33g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

• Foxtail millet (uncooked, rinsed) – 3/4 cup (120g)
• Water – 1.5 cups (360ml)
• Olive oil (or avocado oil) – 1 tablespoon
• Cumin seeds – 1 teaspoon
• Bay leaf – 1
• Cinnamon stick – 1 inch
• Cloves – 2
• Green cardamom pods – 2
• Onion (medium, thinly sliced) – 1
• Ginger (fresh, grated) – 1 teaspoon
• Garlic (fresh, minced) – 2 cloves
• Carrot (diced) – 1/2 cup
• Green beans (chopped) – 1/2 cup

- Green peas (fresh or frozen) – 1/2 cup
- Red bell pepper (chopped) – 1/2 cup
- Cauliflower florets – 1/2 cup
- Low sodium vegetable broth – 1/4 cup
- Plain unsweetened Greek yogurt (low-fat) – 1/4 cup
- Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon
- Ground coriander – 1 teaspoon
- Ground cumin – 1/2 teaspoon
- Garam masala (salt-free) – 1/2 teaspoon
- Black pepper (fresh ground) – 1/4 teaspoon
- Fresh cilantro (chopped) – 2 tablespoons
- Fresh mint leaves (chopped) – 1 tablespoon
- Lemon juice (fresh) – 2 teaspoons

Instructions

1. Rinse millet thoroughly under running water. Drain and set aside.
2. Set Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add olive oil. Once hot, add cumin seeds, bay leaf, cinnamon stick, cloves, and cardamom pods. Sauté for 30 seconds until fragrant.
3. Add sliced onion. Sauté for 3–4 minutes until soft and translucent.
4. Stir in grated ginger and minced garlic. Sauté for 1 minute.
5. Add carrots, green beans, green peas, bell pepper, and cauliflower. Sauté for 2 minutes.
6. Add turmeric, coriander, cumin, garam masala, and black pepper. Mix well.
7. Add rinsed millet. Stir gently to combine.
8. Pour in water and low sodium vegetable broth. Scrape any stuck bits from the bottom.
9. Turn off 'Sauté' mode. Add Greek yogurt and mix gently.
10. Secure the Instant Pot lid. Set to 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' mode, high pressure, for 7 minutes.
11. Allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then carefully quick-release remaining pressure.
12. Open lid, fluff biryani gently with a fork. Remove bay leaf, cinnamon, cloves, and cardamom pods.
13. Fold in chopped cilantro, mint, and drizzle fresh lemon juice before serving.

Low Sodium Mediterranean Lentil & Vegetable Stew (Instant Pot)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 230 kcal
Protein: 13g
Carbs: 34g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

- 1 cup dried green or brown lentils, rinsed and drained
- 1 cup cauliflower florets, chopped small
- 1 medium zucchini, diced
- 1 medium carrot, peeled and diced
- 1 cup fresh spinach, chopped
- 1 medium yellow onion, diced
- 2 cloves garlic, minced
- 1 can (14.5 oz) no-salt-added diced tomatoes
- 2 tablespoons tomato paste (no added salt)
- 3 cups water
- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon dried oregano
- 1 teaspoon dried basil
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1/2 teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- Juice and zest of 1 lemon
- 2 tablespoons chopped fresh parsley (for garnish)

Instructions

1. Set the Instant Pot to sauté mode. Add olive oil and onions, and cook, stirring, for 3-4 minutes until onions are soft.
2. Add garlic, carrot, cauliflower, and zucchini. Sauté for another 2-3 minutes.
3. Stir in cumin, smoked paprika, oregano, basil, and black pepper. Cook for 1 minute to toast spices.
4. Add rinsed lentils, no-salt-added diced tomatoes (with their juice), tomato paste, and water. Stir well, scraping up any browned bits.
5. Seal Instant Pot lid. Set to Manual/Pressure Cook for 15 minutes.
6. After cooking, allow a natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then carefully quick-release any remaining pressure.
7. Open lid. Stir in chopped spinach, lemon zest, and lemon juice. Let sit for 2-3 minutes until spinach wilts.

8. Ladle into bowls and garnish with fresh parsley before serving.

Lauki (Bottle Gourd) and Lentil Curry with Quinoa

Nutritional Information

Calories: 220 kcal
Protein: 12 g
Carbs: 32 g
Fat: 4 g

Ingredients

• 1 cup peeled and diced lauki (bottle gourd) (~150g)
• 1/2 cup split yellow moong dal (lentils), rinsed
• 1/2 cup uncooked quinoa, rinsed
• 1 small onion, finely chopped
• 1 medium tomato, finely chopped
• 1 teaspoon grated fresh ginger
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1/2 teaspoon turmeric powder
• 1/2 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/2 teaspoon ground coriander
• 1/4 teaspoon freshly ground black pepper
• 1/2 teaspoon garam masala (salt-free)
• 1 tablespoon extra virgin olive oil
• 2 1/2 cups water (for curry)
• 1 cup water (for quinoa)
• 1/2 cup chopped fresh spinach (optional, for extra nutrients)
• 2 tablespoons chopped fresh cilantro (for garnish, optional)
• Juice of 1/2 lemon
• No added salt (use potassium-based salt substitute only if approved by healthcare provider)

Instructions

1. Rinse moong dal and quinoa thoroughly under running water.
2. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add olive oil. When hot, add onions and sauté for 2-3 minutes until translucent.
3. Add ginger and garlic. Sauté for 30 seconds until aromatic.
4. Add tomatoes, turmeric, cumin, coriander, and black pepper. Cook for 2-3 minutes, stirring occasionally, until tomatoes soften.
5. Add diced lauki. Stir for 1 minute.
6. Add rinsed moong dal, 2 1/2 cups water, and (if using) spinach. Mix well. Cancel 'Sauté' mode.
7. Seal the Instant Pot lid. Set to 'Pressure Cook' or 'Manual' for 8 minutes on high pressure.
8. While curry cooks, combine rinsed quinoa and 1 cup water in a microwave-safe bowl. Microwave on high, covered, for 10-12 minutes, stirring halfway, until water is absorbed. Fluff with fork. (Alternatively, cook quinoa in Instant Pot after curry, if preferred.)
9. After curry is done, allow natural pressure release for 10 minutes, then quick release any remaining pressure.
10. Stir in garam masala and lemon juice. Adjust seasoning (no added salt).
11. Serve 1/2 cup curry over 1/2 cup cooked quinoa. Garnish with chopped cilantro if desired.

Air-Fried Masala Broccoli with Grilled Halloumi

Nutritional Information

Calories: 210 kcal
Protein: 15g
Carbs: 8g
Fat: 13g

Ingredients

• Broccoli florets – 300g (about 4 cups)
• Low-fat halloumi cheese (reduced sodium if available) – 100g
• Olive oil – 1 tablespoon
• Lemon juice – 1 tablespoon
• Fresh ginger, grated – 1 teaspoon
• Garlic powder – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground cumin – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground coriander – 1/2 teaspoon

• Smoked paprika – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground turmeric – 1/4 teaspoon
• Black pepper, freshly ground – 1/4 teaspoon
• Chopped fresh cilantro (optional) – 1 tablespoon

Instructions

1. 1. Preheat your air fryer to 190°C (375°F).
2. 2. In a large bowl, combine olive oil, lemon juice, grated ginger, garlic powder, cumin, coriander, smoked paprika, turmeric, and black pepper. Mix well to form a marinade.
3. 3. Add broccoli florets to the bowl and toss thoroughly to coat them evenly with the masala marinade.
4. 4. Place the marinated broccoli in the air fryer basket in a single layer. Air-fry for 8-10 minutes, shaking the basket halfway through, until the broccoli is crisp and slightly charred at the edges.
5. 5. While the broccoli is cooking, slice the halloumi into 1 cm-thick slices.
6. 6. Heat a non-stick grill pan or skillet over medium heat (or use your air fryer if it has a grill tray function). Grill the halloumi slices for 1-2 minutes per side until golden and lightly charred.
7. 7. Serve the air-fried masala broccoli with grilled halloumi on top. Garnish with chopped fresh cilantro if desired.

Zucchini Noodles with Spicy Marinara and Grilled Tofu

Nutritional Information

Calories: 230 kcal
Protein: 17g
Carbs: 19g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 2 medium zucchinis (about 300g total), spiralized into noodles
• 200g extra-firm tofu, pressed and sliced into 1 cm thick slabs
• 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil, divided
• 1 cup (240g) no-salt-added diced tomatoes (canned or fresh)

• 2 tablespoons tomato paste (no salt added)
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1/2 medium yellow onion (about 60g), finely diced
• 1/2 red bell pepper (about 50g), finely diced
• 1/2 teaspoon crushed red pepper flakes (adjust to taste)
• 1 teaspoon dried Italian herbs (basil, oregano, thyme mix)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1 tablespoon fresh basil, chopped (optional, for garnish)
• 1 tablespoon nutritional yeast (optional, for cheesy flavor)
• 1/2 teaspoon lemon zest (optional, for brightness)
• Non-stick cooking spray (for grilling tofu)

Instructions

1. 1. Press the tofu: Place tofu between two plates with a heavy object on top for 15–20 minutes to remove excess water. Then, slice into 1 cm thick slabs.
2. 2. Prepare zucchini noodles: Spiralize the zucchinis using a spiralizer or julienne peeler. Set aside on paper towels to remove excess moisture.
3. 3. Make the spicy marinara: In a non-stick skillet or Instant Pot (sauté mode), heat 2 teaspoons of olive oil over medium heat. Add diced onion, red bell pepper, and garlic. Sauté for 3–4 minutes until softened.
4. 4. Add diced tomatoes, tomato paste, crushed red pepper flakes, Italian herbs, and black pepper. Simmer for 10–15 minutes, stirring occasionally, until slightly thickened. If desired, blend briefly with an immersion blender for a smoother sauce. Taste and adjust spice as needed.
5. 5. Grill the tofu: Lightly spray tofu slabs with non-stick spray and brush lightly with remaining olive oil. Air fry at 375°F (190°C) for 10–12 minutes, flipping halfway, until golden and crisp. (Alternatively, use a non-stick skillet.)
6. 6. Cook zucchini noodles: In a large non-stick skillet, sauté zucchini noodles for 2–3 minutes over medium heat until just tender. Do not overcook; they should remain slightly crisp.
7. 7. Assemble: Plate zucchini noodles, top with spicy marinara, and arrange grilled tofu on top. Sprinkle with nutritional yeast, fresh basil, and lemon zest if desired.
8. 8. Serve immediately. Enjoy!

Low-Sodium Vegetarian Stuffed Bell Peppers with Black Beans and Corn

Nutritional Information

Calories: 195 kcal
Protein: 9g
Carbs: 28g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• 4 large bell peppers (any color), tops cut off, seeds removed
• 1 cup cooked black beans (no salt added, rinsed if canned)
• 3/4 cup frozen corn kernels (no salt added), thawed
• 1/2 cup cooked quinoa (for lower carb, use only 1/2 cup; can substitute with riced cauliflower for even lower carb)
• 1/2 cup diced tomatoes (no salt added, drained)
• 1/3 cup red onion, finely diced
• 2 cloves garlic, minced
• 1 tablespoon olive oil
• 1 teaspoon ground cumin
• 1/2 teaspoon smoked paprika
• 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
• 1/4 teaspoon chili powder (optional, for flavor)
• 1/4 cup fresh cilantro or parsley, chopped
• 1/2 cup reduced-fat shredded cheddar cheese (or dairy-free cheese, optional)
• 2 tablespoons fresh lime juice

Instructions

1. Preheat air fryer to 350°F (175°C) or Instant Pot on sauté mode if using.
2. In a large skillet or Instant Pot on sauté mode, heat olive oil. Add onions and garlic, sauté for 2–3 minutes until softened.
3. Add black beans, corn, quinoa (or riced cauliflower), diced tomatoes, cumin, paprika, black pepper, and chili powder. Stir well and cook for 5 minutes until mixture is heated through.
4. Remove from heat. Stir in fresh cilantro (or parsley) and lime juice. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed (avoid added salt).
5. Fill each prepared bell pepper with the bean and corn mixture. Top with shredded cheese if using.
6. Place stuffed peppers upright in the air fryer basket or Instant Pot trivet. Air fry at 350°F (175°C) for 10–12 minutes, or until peppers are tender and cheese is melted. If using Instant Pot, add 1 cup water to the bottom, place peppers on trivet, and pressure cook on high for 5 minutes with quick release.
7. Let cool slightly before serving.

Low-Sodium Cabbage and Paneer Stir-Fry with Garlic

Nutritional Information

Calories: 225 kcal
Protein: 16 g
Carbs: 10 g
Fat: 13 g

Ingredients

• Fresh paneer (low-fat, unsalted if possible) – 150g, cubed
• Green cabbage – 250g, thinly sliced
• Red bell pepper – 50g, thinly sliced
• Carrot – 40g, julienned
• Fresh garlic – 3 cloves, finely minced
• Fresh ginger – 1 tsp, grated
• Olive oil (extra virgin) – 1.5 tsp
• Black pepper – 1/4 tsp, freshly ground
• Lemon juice – 1 tbsp
• Fresh cilantro – 1 tbsp, chopped (optional)
• Water – 2 tbsp

Instructions

1. Pat paneer cubes dry with a paper towel to reduce moisture.
2. Set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode (or use a non-stick pan if preferred). Add 1 tsp olive oil.
3. Add paneer cubes, sauté for 2–3 minutes until lightly golden on most sides. Remove paneer and set aside.
4. Add remaining 0.5 tsp olive oil, then add minced garlic and ginger. Sauté for 30 seconds until fragrant.
5. Add sliced cabbage, bell pepper, and carrot. Stir well. Add 2 tbsp water to help steam the vegetables.
6. Cover with the Instant Pot lid (do NOT seal for pressure cooking) or a regular pan lid, and cook for 3–5 minutes, stirring occasionally, until vegetables are crisp-tender.

7. Return paneer to the pot. Add black pepper and lemon juice. Toss to combine and heat through for 1–2 minutes.
8. Garnish with fresh cilantro if desired. Serve warm.

Eggplant and Chickpea Curry with Brown Rice

Nutritional Information

Calories: 312 kcal
Protein: 11g
Carbs: 51g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• Eggplant (aubergine), diced – 350g (about 1 medium)
• Cooked chickpeas (no salt added, rinsed if canned) – 240g (1.5 cups)
• Brown basmati rice (dry) – 90g (1/2 cup)
• Onion, finely chopped – 80g (1 small)
• Tomatoes, chopped – 200g (2 small-medium)
• Fresh spinach leaves – 60g (2 cups lightly packed)
• Garlic, minced – 2 cloves
• Fresh ginger, minced – 1 tsp
• Canola or olive oil – 2 tsp
• Ground cumin – 1 tsp
• Ground coriander – 1 tsp
• Turmeric – 1/2 tsp
• Smoked paprika – 1/2 tsp
• Ground black pepper – 1/4 tsp
• Fresh lemon juice – 2 tsp
• Fresh cilantro (coriander leaves), chopped – 2 tbsp (optional)
• Water – 250ml (1 cup)
• No-salt-added vegetable broth – 120ml (1/2 cup)

Instructions

1. Rinse the brown rice thoroughly under cold running water. In the Instant Pot, add the rice and 1 cup (250ml) water. Cook on high pressure for 20 minutes, then let pressure release naturally for 10 minutes. Fluff and set aside.
2. While rice is cooking, set the Instant Pot to 'Sauté' mode. Add 2 tsp oil, then the chopped onions. Sauté for 3-4 minutes until translucent.
3. Add minced garlic and ginger. Sauté for 1 minute until fragrant.
4. Add diced eggplant, cumin, coriander, turmeric, smoked paprika, and black pepper. Stir well and sauté for 2-3 minutes.
5. Add chopped tomatoes and cook for another 2 minutes to soften.
6. Add chickpeas, vegetable broth, and stir to combine. Cancel 'Sauté' mode.
7. Secure lid, set Instant Pot to 'Manual' or 'Pressure Cook' for 4 minutes. Once done, quick release the pressure.
8. Remove the lid, stir in the spinach, and let wilt in the residual heat (1-2 minutes). Stir in lemon juice and optional cilantro.
9. Serve curry over a portion of brown rice.

Roasted Chana and Spiced Almonds

Nutritional Information

Calories: 170 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 9g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• Roasted unsalted chana (whole, with skin) – 1/2 cup (60g)
• Raw unsalted almonds – 1/2 cup (70g)
• Olive oil (extra virgin) – 1 teaspoon (5ml)
• Smoked paprika (or regular paprika) – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground cumin – 1/2 teaspoon
• Ground coriander – 1/4 teaspoon
• Black pepper – 1/4 teaspoon
• Turmeric powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Lemon zest – 1/2 teaspoon (optional, for flavor)
• Fresh cilantro or parsley – 1 tablespoon, finely chopped (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 160°C (320°F).
2. In a large bowl, combine the almonds and roasted chana.
3. Drizzle the olive oil over the nuts and chana. Mix well to coat evenly.
4. Sprinkle in the smoked paprika, cumin, coriander, black pepper, and turmeric. Mix thoroughly to ensure all pieces are well coated with spices.
5. Spread the mixture evenly in the air fryer basket. Air fry for 7-8 minutes, shaking once halfway through, until almonds are golden and fragrant. (If using an oven, bake at 160°C/320°F for 10-12 minutes, stirring halfway.)
6. Remove from the air fryer and allow to cool for 10 minutes. Optional: Sprinkle lemon zest and fresh chopped cilantro or parsley for added flavor.
7. Serve as a snack, or store in an airtight container for up to 1 week.

Sliced Apple with High-Protein Peanut Butter Spread (Diabetes-Friendly, Low Sodium)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 5g
Carbs: 14g
Fat: 6g

Ingredients

• 1 small crisp apple (e.g. Granny Smith, ~140g)
• 1 tablespoon natural unsalted peanut butter (16g), no added sugar or salt
• 1 tablespoon plain low-fat Greek yogurt (optional, for higher protein, ~15g)
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon (optional)

Instructions

1. Wash the apple thoroughly. Core and slice it into 8-10 wedges.

2. In a small bowl, mix the peanut butter with the plain Greek yogurt (if using) until smooth. This boosts protein and lightens texture without adding sodium or sugar.
3. Arrange the apple slices on a plate.
4. Spread or dollop the peanut butter mixture evenly over the apple slices.
5. Sprinkle with ground cinnamon, if desired, for extra flavor without added sugar or salt.
6. Serve immediately to prevent browning.

Diabetes-Friendly Pumpkin Seed Trail Mix

Nutritional Information

Calories: 180 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 7g (net carbs: 4g, fiber: 3g)
Fat: 15g

Ingredients

• Pumpkin seeds (unsalted, raw or dry roasted) – 1/2 cup (60g)
• Almonds (unsalted, raw or dry roasted) – 1/4 cup (30g)
• Walnuts (unsalted, raw or dry roasted) – 1/4 cup (28g)
• Unsweetened coconut flakes – 2 tablespoons (10g)
• Dried cranberries (no sugar added, unsweetened) – 2 tablespoons (16g)
• Chia seeds – 1 tablespoon (10g)
• Ground cinnamon – 1/4 teaspoon

Instructions

1. In a large mixing bowl, combine the pumpkin seeds, almonds, and walnuts.
2. Add the unsweetened coconut flakes, dried cranberries, and chia seeds.
3. Sprinkle ground cinnamon over the mixture.
4. Toss all ingredients together until evenly combined.
5. Store the trail mix in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 2 weeks.

6. Portion into 1/4 cup servings when ready to eat.

Walnut & Herb Protein Power Spread

Nutritional Information

Calories: 130 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 4g
Fat: 10g

Ingredients

• 1 cup raw walnuts (unsalted, unroasted)
• 1/2 cup low-fat cottage cheese (lactose-free if needed, no added salt)
• 1/4 cup firm tofu (drained, pressed)
• 2 tbsp fresh parsley (chopped)
• 2 tbsp fresh chives (chopped)
• 1 tbsp fresh lemon juice
• 1 small garlic clove
• 1/4 tsp ground black pepper (optional)
• 2 tbsp water (as needed for texture)

Instructions

1. Add walnuts to a blender. Pulse until finely ground.
2. Add cottage cheese, tofu, parsley, chives, lemon juice, garlic, and black pepper to the blender.
3. Blend until smooth, stopping to scrape down sides as needed. If the mixture is too thick, add water 1 tablespoon at a time until desired spreadable consistency is reached.
4. Transfer to a bowl. Taste and adjust seasonings if needed (avoid adding salt).
5. Refrigerate for at least 30 minutes to allow flavors to meld. Serve chilled as a dip with raw non-starchy vegetables or as a spread on gluten-free, whole-grain crispbread.

Low-Sugar Protein-Packed Dried Berry Snack Mix

Nutritional Information

Calories: 185 kcal
Protein: 7g
Carbs: 13g
Fat: 12g

Ingredients

• 30g unsweetened dried blueberries (about 1/4 cup)
• 30g unsweetened dried cranberries (about 1/4 cup)
• 40g roasted, unsalted pumpkin seeds (about 1/4 cup)
• 30g roasted, unsalted almonds (about 1/4 cup, chopped)
• 20g roasted, unsalted sunflower seeds (about 2 tablespoons)
• 1 tablespoon chia seeds (12g)
• 1/2 teaspoon ground cinnamon

Instructions

1. 1. Ensure all dried berries are unsweetened and with no added sugar or sodium. If using packaged dried berries, check the nutrition label for no added sugars or salt.
2. 2. In a large bowl, add the dried blueberries, dried cranberries, pumpkin seeds, chopped almonds, sunflower seeds, and chia seeds.
3. 3. Sprinkle the ground cinnamon evenly over the mixture.
4. 4. Using a spatula or clean hands, gently toss the ingredients until well mixed.
5. 5. Store the mix in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 2 weeks. Portion into individual servings (about 1/3 cup per serving) for easy snack management.
6. 6. Serve as a high-protein, low-sugar, low-sodium snack, or sprinkle over plain Greek yogurt (unsweetened, if not vegan) for a more filling meal.

Air-Fried Spicy Chickpeas (Low Sodium, Diabetic-Friendly)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 120 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 16g
Fat: 4g

Ingredients

- 1 (15 oz/425g) can no-salt-added chickpeas (garbanzo beans), drained and rinsed thoroughly
- 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 teaspoon smoked paprika
- 1/2 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1/4 teaspoon garlic powder
- 1/4 teaspoon onion powder
- 1/4 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1/8 teaspoon cayenne pepper (optional, adjust for spice preference)
- 1/2 teaspoon lemon zest (freshly grated)

Instructions

1. Preheat the air fryer to 390°F (200°C) for 3 minutes.
2. Drain and rinse the chickpeas very well under cold water. Pat them completely dry with paper towels—removing as much moisture as possible will help them crisp.
3. In a medium bowl, combine the olive oil, smoked paprika, cumin, garlic powder, onion powder, black pepper, cayenne pepper (if using), and lemon zest. Mix well.
4. Add the dried chickpeas to the bowl and toss until they are evenly coated with the spice mixture.
5. Spread the chickpeas in a single layer in the air fryer basket. Avoid overcrowding; cook in batches if necessary.
6. Air fry for 12–15 minutes, shaking the basket every 5 minutes, until chickpeas are golden brown and crispy. Watch closely after 10 minutes to prevent burning.
7. Remove and let cool for 5 minutes—they will continue to crisp as they cool. Serve as a snack or salad topping.

Cucumber Sticks with Low-Sodium High-Protein Hummus

Nutritional Information

Calories: 150 kcal
Protein: 6g
Carbs: 16g
Fat: 7g

Ingredients

- 1 large English cucumber (approx. 300g)
- 1 can (400g/15oz) no-salt-added chickpeas, drained and rinsed
- 3 tablespoons tahini (unsalted, no added oil)
- 2 tablespoons freshly squeezed lemon juice
- 2 tablespoons water (more if needed for texture)
- 1 small garlic clove, minced
- 1 tablespoon extra-virgin olive oil
- 1/4 teaspoon ground cumin
- 1/8 teaspoon ground black pepper
- 1 tablespoon chopped fresh parsley (optional, for garnish)

Instructions

1. Wash the cucumber thoroughly. Cut off the ends, then slice into sticks approximately 3-4 inches long and 1/2 inch thick. Set aside in the fridge to chill.
2. In a blender or food processor, add the drained and rinsed chickpeas, tahini, lemon juice, water, minced garlic, olive oil, cumin, and black pepper.
3. Blend until completely smooth. If the mixture is too thick, add an extra tablespoon of water at a time until the desired creamy consistency is reached.
4. Taste and adjust seasoning as needed (do not add salt to maintain low-sodium compliance).
5. Transfer the hummus to a serving bowl. Drizzle with a small amount of additional olive oil (optional) and sprinkle with chopped parsley for garnish.
6. Serve cucumber sticks alongside the hummus for dipping.
7. Store any leftover hummus in an airtight container in the fridge for up to 4 days.

Greek Yogurt with Blueberries and Chia Seeds (Diabetes & Heart-Healthy)

Nutritional Information

Calories: 115 kcal
Protein: 15 g
Carbs: 9 g
Fat: 1.5 g

Ingredients

• 3/4 cup (170g) plain, non-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened, low sodium)
• 1/4 cup (40g) fresh blueberries (or frozen, unsweetened, thawed and drained)
• 1 teaspoon (4g) chia seeds
• 1/4 teaspoon ground cinnamon (optional, for flavor, no salt or sugar)
• 1/2 teaspoon vanilla extract (alcohol-free, optional)
• 1-2 drops liquid stevia or monk fruit sweetener (optional; avoid added sugar)

Instructions

1. Place the Greek yogurt in a serving bowl.
2. Add the vanilla extract and cinnamon (if using) to the yogurt and stir well.
3. Sprinkle the chia seeds evenly over the yogurt.
4. Top with fresh blueberries.
5. If desired, add 1-2 drops of liquid stevia or monk fruit sweetener and mix gently (avoid using honey, agave, or maple syrup due to high sugar content).
6. Let sit for 5 minutes to allow chia seeds to hydrate (optional, improves texture and digestion).
7. Serve immediately, or refrigerate for up to 1 hour for a chilled snack.

Carrot and Celery Sticks with Spicy Roasted Moong Dip

Nutritional Information

Calories: 160 kcal
Protein: 8g
Carbs: 18g
Fat: 5g

Ingredients

• Carrots, fresh, peeled – 100g (about 1 medium carrot)
• Celery stalks, fresh – 100g (about 2 large stalks)
• Moong dal (split green gram), dry – 60g (1/3 cup)
• Olive oil, extra virgin – 2 teaspoons
• Fresh lemon juice – 1 tablespoon
• Garlic, fresh, minced – 1 small clove
• Cumin powder – 1/4 teaspoon
• Smoked paprika – 1/4 teaspoon (optional for spice)
• Black pepper, freshly ground – 1/8 teaspoon
• Fresh coriander leaves, chopped – 1 tablespoon
• Filtered water – 2 tablespoons (adjust as needed)
• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional, check with doctor) – pinch (optional and only if approved)

Instructions

1. Rinse the moong dal thoroughly. Soak in water for 1 hour, then drain.
2. Preheat the Air Fryer to 180°C (360°F). Spread the soaked, drained moong dal on the air fryer basket in a single layer. Air fry for 10–12 minutes, shaking gently halfway, until golden and crisp. Let cool.
3. In a blender, add the roasted moong dal, minced garlic, cumin powder, smoked paprika, black pepper, and lemon juice. Add 2 teaspoons olive oil and 2 tablespoons water.
4. Blend to a smooth dip, scraping down as needed. If too thick, add more water, 1 teaspoon at a time, to reach a creamy consistency.
5. Taste and, if approved by healthcare provider, add a pinch of potassium-based salt substitute. Stir in chopped coriander.
6. Peel the carrot and cut into sticks. Wash celery and cut into sticks.
7. Arrange carrot and celery sticks on a plate. Serve with the spicy roasted moong dip.

Shopping List

Dry Goods

- Chia seeds - 100 g
- Split yellow moong dal (mung beans, dry) - 400 g
- Steel-cut oats, gluten-free - 300 g
- Little millet or foxtail millet (dry) - 300 g
- Brown or green lentils (dry) - 500 g
- Besan (chickpea flour) - 500 g
- Cooked quinoa (uncooked for purchase) - 500 g
- Brown basmati rice (dry) - 500 g
- Foxtail millet (uncooked, rinsed) - see above
- Roasted unsalted chana (whole, with skin) - 100 g
- Dried red kidney beans (rajma) - 200 g
- Cooked chickpeas (no salt added, or dry) - 600 g
- Black beans (no salt added, or dry) - 200 g

Dairy Alternatives

- Unsweetened almond milk - 500 ml
- Unsweetened soy milk (fortified) - 500 ml

Baking

- Vanilla extract (alcohol-free) - 100 ml
- Stevia or monk fruit sweetener - 1 bottle
- Unsweetened coconut flakes - 50 g

• Nutritional yeast - 50 g

Produce

• Mixed berries (raspberries, blueberries, strawberries) - 1 lb
• Fresh spinach leaves - 908 g (2 × 454 g bags)
• Carrot - 2 lb
• Red onion - 2 lb
• Fresh coriander leaves (cilantro) - 3 bunches
• Green chili - 0.25 lb
• Ginger - 0.5 lb
• Fresh mint leaves - 2 bunches
• Lemon juice (fresh lemons) - 8 pieces
• Red bell pepper - 3 lb
• Yellow bell pepper - 1 lb
• Onion (yellow or white) - 3 lb
• Garlic - 2 bulbs
• Parsley (flat or curly) - 3 bunches
• Green beans - 1 lb
• Cilantro/coriander (for garnish) - see above
• Celery - 1 lb
• Zucchini - 3 pieces (≈2 lb)
• Tomatoes (fresh or canned, no-salt-added) - 2 lb fresh + 2 × 400 g cans
• Fresh spinach - 908 g (2 × 454 g bags)
• Cherry tomatoes - 1 lb
• Cucumber (English or regular) - 4 pieces
• Avocado - 3 pieces
• Baby spinach (for salad blends) - 454 g (1 bag)
• Romaine lettuce - 2 heads
• Arugula (salad blend) - 454 g (1 bag)
• Eggplant - 2 pieces (≈2 lb)
• Romaine or butter lettuce (for wraps) - 1 head
• Cabbage (green) - 1 head (≈2 lb)
• Bottle gourd (lauki) - 1 piece (≈1 lb)
• Fresh chives - 1 bunch

- Apple (crisp such as Granny Smith) - 1 lb
- Thai basil (or extra cilantro/mint for garnish) - 1 bunch

Supplements

- Plant-based protein powder (unflavored or vanilla, low-carb, low-sodium) - 100 g

Beverages

- Filtered water - 4 l

Spices

- Cumin seeds - 100 g
- Turmeric powder - 100 g
- Black pepper - 100 g
- Roasted cumin powder - 50 g
- Smoked paprika - 100 g
- Ground cinnamon - 50 g
- Mustard seeds - 50 g
- Dried thyme - 50 g
- Dried oregano - 50 g
- Bay leaf - 1 package
- Garam masala (salt free) - 50 g
- Dried basil - 50 g
- Cinnamon stick - 1 package
- Cloves - 1 package
- Green cardamom pods - 1 package

Oils & Vinegars

• Extra-virgin olive oil - 500 ml

Seasonings

• Salt substitute (potassium-based, optional) - 1 bottle

Dairy

• Plain low-fat Greek yogurt (unsweetened, no added sodium) - 1 kg
• Low-fat, unsalted paneer - 500 g
• Greek yogurt (plain, low fat, for sauces/marinades) - see above
• Low-fat cottage cheese (unsalted) - 250 g
• Low-fat halloumi cheese (reduced sodium if available) - 100 g
• Paneer (low-fat, unsalted) - see above
• Reduced-fat shredded cheddar cheese (or dairy-free cheese) - 200 g
• Plain low-fat Greek yogurt (for optional dips/spreads) - see above

Refrigerated Vegan

• Firm/extra-firm tofu - 1 kg

Nuts & Seeds

- Chopped raw walnuts - 100 g
- Unsalted roasted peanuts - 100 g
- Raw walnuts - 250 g
- Raw or dry roasted almonds (unsalted) - 250 g
- Pumpkin seeds (unsalted) - 150 g
- Sunflower seeds (unsalted) - 50 g
- Flaxseed, ground - 100 g

Frozen

- Frozen green peas - 454 g (1 bag)
- Frozen corn kernels (no salt added) - 454 g (1 bag)

Condiments

- Low-sodium soy sauce or tamari - 100 ml
- Tahini (unsalted, no added oil) - 250 g
- Thai red curry paste (low sodium, vegetarian) - 100 g jar
- Tamari (low sodium, gluten-free soy sauce) - 100 ml

Canned Goods

- No-salt-added diced tomatoes (canned) - 4 × 400 g cans
- Low-sodium vegetable broth - 2 l
- Light coconut milk (unsweetened) - 400 ml

Dried Fruits

- Dried cranberries (unsweetened, no sugar added) - 50 g
- Dried blueberries (unsweetened, no sugar added) - 50 g

Nut Butters

- Natural unsalted peanut butter (no sugar or salt) - 250 g jar